

Assessment Guide

Design Journal 2: Week 7 (10 %)

Individual Task

Please submit .pdf via Moodle.

Task

A *design journal* serves as a logbook for your design project work. Design journals serve many purposes:

- *Creativity and communication*: An aid for inventiveness in the design process and a valuable source to collect material to communicate the design.
- *Legal*: Keeps an official record of information that can be used as evidence in legal disputes, such as intellectual property or safety incidences.
- *Operations*: Tracks the process for convenient monitoring and handover of important information.

It is a place where you can discuss your design ideas, reflect on your experiences, collect research findings and much more. There is no exact way to write a design journal. However, a good rule of thumb on what to include is:

What to include – and what not

Here is a long (but non-exhaustive) list of things you could include: meeting minutes, project schedules (i.e. Gantt chart), screenshots of your team's planner, scrum board, team task assignments, annotated concept sketches, desk research findings, pictures, case-study analysis, mind maps, moodboards, new design ideas, diagrams, tables, infographics, referenced screenshots with source links, results of team discussions, personas, user journey, etc.

Keep in mind that this is a professional document, so do not include funny photographs of your dog or diary entries of what you had for breakfast. Also, do not copy in-class materials. If required, link to those and reference them appropriately.

In this design journal, we also want to see your reflections on your experiences, highlighting what you have done, evaluating it and outlining what you might do in future based on what you have learned through this experience.

If it is related to your design project work, then it's okay to include in your journal

Format

Your journal is an active record of your design work (from research to concept generation). The report in PDF format is to be submitted in Moodle. Late penalties will be applied as per the course outline policy (flat -5% penalty per day).

Page limit: the main body of the Design Journal is limited to **15 pages of text**. Note that the length limit excludes the title page, images, figures, references and appendices.

Guidelines

There is no one *right* way to write a design journal. However, there are some practices you can adopt to improve the overall quality of your journal: have a structure, define and follow a format, use different tools to visualise your process and outcomes.

Structure

It is recommended that you organise your journal entries into the steps of your design journey following the structure of lectures and workshops in weeks 4-7 of the course.

Table 1 summarises key assessment details.

Table 1 Summary of crucial assessment details

Type	Individual submission
Submission	Submit to Moodle
Due date	Sunday, Week 7 23:00 PM
Weighting	10%
Marking	Marked by the demonstrator and moderated by coordinators
Late entries	Flat -5% penalty per day

Marking

The assessment will be marked by a course demonstrators and moderated by course coordinators. Marks and feedback will be returned within two weeks of submission. The marking rubric outlines how your journal will be marked. Please read it carefully.

Table 2 Marking rubric.

Technical concept				
<i>Missing</i>	<i>Incomplete</i>	<i>Partial</i>	<i>Systematic</i>	<i>Innovative</i>
There is only one technical concept but it does not have justification in research.	There are 2-3 technical concepts. A systematic selection method has been used to rank them. The concepts remain sketches: no technical detail is given.	There are 2-3 technical concepts. A systematic selection method has been used to rank them. The selected concept identifies main technical problems and breaks them down into a development plan.	There are 2-3 technical concepts. A systematic selection method has been used to rank them. The selected concept identifies main technical problems and breaks them down into a development plan. The concepts analyse subsystems involved and discusses their integration.	There are 2-3 technical concepts. A systematic selection method has been used to rank them. The selected concept identifies main technical problems and breaks them down into a development plan. The concepts analyse subsystems involved and discusses their integration. The concept is innovative and the claim about its innovative quality builds on research evidence.
0	10	15	20	25
Technical development				
<i>Missing</i>	<i>Incomplete</i>	<i>Partial</i>	<i>Systematic</i>	<i>Innovative</i>
There is only one technical concept that has not changed during Weeks 3-7.	The team has selected a concept using a systematic method. Entries show development of the selected concept during Weeks 3-7.	The team has selected a concept using a systematic method. Entries show development of the selected concept during Weeks 3-7. The development extends to subsystems and their integration.	The team has selected a concept or created a new concept from parts using a systematic method and may have selected a contingency. Entries show development of the selected concept/s during Weeks 3-7. The development is extends to subsystems and their integration. At each stage of development, there is evidence of a systematic method used in selecting among the alternatives.	The team has selected a concept or created a new concept from parts using a systematic method and may have selected a contingency. Entries show development of the selected concept/s during Weeks 3-7. The development extends to subsystems and their integration. At each stage of development, there is evidence of a systematic method used in selecting among the alternatives. At every stage of development, there is evidence of research into existing technical alternatives and evidence that shows that the concept is innovative.
0	10	15	20	25
Project Management and Teamwork				
<i>Missing</i>	<i>Incomplete</i>	<i>Partial</i>	<i>Systematic</i>	<i>Innovative</i>
Weekly journal entries are missing, entries show little to no effort made, and the entries show no contribution to the team.	Some weekly journal entries are missing. Entries do not include meeting minutes and a project schedule. They show no contribution to the team.	A journal entry is made at least once a week. Entries do not include meeting minutes or a project schedule. There is evidence showing that the team member has made a contribution to the team.	Several journal entries are made each week. Entries include meeting minutes and a project schedule. There is evidence showing that the team member has made a contribution to the team by participating in problem definition, research, analysis, and concept creation, as well as defining technical solutions.	Numerous journal entries are made each week. Consistently includes meeting minutes, documents their work, and uses a project schedule. There is evidence showing that the team member has made a contribution to the team by participating in problem definition, research, analysis, and concept creation, as well as defining technical solutions. The entries show evidence of innovative thinking in creating the solution.
0	5	10	15	20

Communication				
Missing	Incomplete	Partial	Systematic	Innovative
Most weekly journal entries are missing, entries show little to no effort.	Entries are incoherent, and irrelevant to the project work. They are not structured and formatted in a way that makes them hard to read. There are no figures or images. There are no references to external sources.	Entries are coherent and relevant to the project work. They are structured and formatted in a way that makes them easy to read. Figures and images have been used. There are references to external sources, and these are mostly relevant.	Entries are coherent and relevant to the project work. They are structured and formatted in a way that makes them easy to read. Figures and images have been used. There are references to external sources. These are mostly relevant and show comprehension of the latest technologies and developments in technology.	Entries are coherent & relevant to the project work. They are structured & formatted in a way that makes them easy to read. Figures & images have been used. There are references to external sources. These are mostly relevant & show comprehension of the latest technologies and developments in technology. Evidence of self evaluation, reflection & forward thinking is demonstrated.
0	10	15	20	30

Format

In general, you should avoid large blocks of text. These walls of writing can make it difficult to quickly extract crucial information. Your marker will have limited time to assess your work, so you should make it easy to digest:

"Lastly, for the sake of the markers, please make the format such that it is easy to follow and award marks (headings and subheadings are strongly recommended)" –!DESN2000 journal marker in 2024

Use headings, paragraphs and dot points to break up your text. You may also format the text to emphasise essential points: bold, coloured or highlighted texts works well. Figures, maps, graphs are essential for a good storytelling and sintesys of your process.

Figures

Images and photos often communicate design better than text. Consider using these regularly within your design journal. Take screenshots or photographs of your mindmaps, drawing, whiteboards, CAD models, sketches, prototype tests and so on. And then put them in your journal with your comments and reflections.

When you insert a figure, be sure to caption, label and reference it appropriately. For example:

Fig. 1 A picture of a car. Source: picturesofcars.com

Please note that Figures are captioned *under* the figure. Tables are captioned *over* the table.

Videos

To add videos, you will first have to upload somewhere else then include a shareable link in your journal. This process can be a bit slow, so it is generally best to avoid videos or only use them when completely necessary.

Logbook

The journal is an active record of your project work. It is a progressive document that should be actively updated as you work on the project instead of being retrospectively filled in just before the due date. Try to form the habit of keeping the record up to date. The authenticity of this is usually quite apparent to markers.

Referencing

You do not need to use a formal referencing system such as IEEE or Harvard. At a minimum, you should provide a link to the source document. However, when you include other references, you cannot present it as your own work (i.e., plagiarise).